Tetzaveh 5783

Any time a person goes up to daven, he will see a sign in front of him in any shul, anywhere around the world: שויתי ה׳ לנגדי תמיד. This is a great זכות, a tremendous obligation, and a remarkable opportunity to constantly keep הקודש ברוך הוא in front of us at all times.

This concept is brought down in this week's פרשה, פרשת תצוה, through an interesting פסוק. In fact, a מדרש פליאה uses this פסוק to make a fascinating point. I heard this vort from my father, עליו השלום, who heard it from Rabbi David Hollander זצ"ל, the מרא דאתרא of Mount Eden Shul in the Bronx, where we grew up. This was his דרשה on פרשת תצוה. The מדרש asks: which מצוה, [in his cute way he would say is the most important מצוה in the תורה, of course it's not such a thing, they're all equally important] if you had to choose just one of the תרי"ג מצוות, includes all the other מצוות? There is a מחלוקת quoted in the introduction of הכותב, a פירוש on עין יעקב.

בן זומא says it's (דברים ו:ד) שְׁמַע יִשְׂרָאֵל ה׳ אֱלֹקֵינוּ ה׳ אֶחָד, where we are מקבל אחדות השם and עול מלכות שמים. בן ננס says it's (ויקרא י״ט:י״ח) וְאָהַבְתָּ לְרֵעֲךָ כָּמוֹךָ which pertains to בין אדם לחבירו, a tremendously important יסוד. Finally, שמעון בן פזי brings down the פסוק from our פרשה: אֶת הַכֶּבֶשׂ הָאֶחָד תַּעֲשֶׂה בַבֹּקֶר וְאֵת הַכֶּבֶשׂ הַשֵּׁנִי תַּעֲשֶׂה בֵּין הָעַרְבָּיִם (שמות כ״ט:ל״ט), referring to the קרבן תמיד.

[רש"י points out that תמיד does not mean it was brought continuously without interruption, but rather that it was brought every single day without הפסק.] Morning and evening, every single day, the קרבן תמיד was offered. Through this קרבן, we represent, signify, and declare שויתי ה׳ לנגדי תמיד, that הקודש ברוך הוא is constantly before us.

In fact, this is the ultimate purpose of all מצוות. Every מצוה is designed to remind us that Hashem is always in front of us. He creates everything, orchestrates all situations, and no matter what circumstance we find ourselves in, it comes from הקב"ה. מצוות such as שבת, יום טוב, ממונות, נזיקין, and קרבנות all teach and reinforce this יסוד.

Why do we specifically have two קרבנות each day - one in the morning and one at night? Many פשטים are offered, but one of the simplest yet most meaningful comes from ספר מעינה של תורה, quoting the הדרש והעיון. A person's life can be divided into two phases: the first half is a time of ascent, and the second half is a time of descent.

In youth, a person is full of כח but lacks the maturity of mind and wisdom of experience. As he ages, wisdom increases while physical כח declines. In all phases of our lives, no matter what we have, we should constantly use the כוחות that we have, the abilities that we have, the blessings that הקודש ברוך הוא gave us, to fulfill the מצוה of the קרבן תמיד, through which we fulfill שויתי ה׳ לנגדי תמיד.

https://youtu.be/KOCUwvG3Apo